

MORNING BRIEFING — MONDAY 17 AUGUST 2026

Generated 17 August 2026 • 06:20 BST (London) • Data collected between 05:00 and 06:15 BST via open web sources • Reference timezone: Europe/London (BST = UTC+1)

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

US retail sales post steepest drop in over a year and consumer sentiment plunges, dollar falls to weakest since May

[CNN Business](#) / [CfO Dive](#) / [Bloomberg](#) • Fri 14 Aug

July retail sales fell 0.6% m/m (worst reading in over a year), with online sales down 2.2% and vehicle sales down 1.8%. The University of Michigan's preliminary August consumer sentiment index dropped to 51.0 from 55.2, ending a two-month recovery, as households cited Iran-war-linked fuel, energy and food costs. The Bloomberg Dollar Spot Index fell 0.4% to its weakest since 29 May as traders further pared September Fed hike bets. Wall Street pulled back from Thursday's record high but the S&P 500 still closed out its third straight weekly gain. Sets a cautious, data-sensitive tone into today's European open.

Iran, Oman and the US reportedly in "final stages" of a Strait of Hormuz shipping deal; still unresolved into Monday

[CNBC](#) / [Al Jazeera](#) / [Yahoo Finance](#) • through the weekend, 14-16 Aug

Talks centre on who controls Hormuz shipping traffic and whether Iran can levy passage fees, with the aim of restoring the 17 June US-Iran ceasefire. No deal has been confirmed as of this morning. War-risk insurance remains at 7.5-10% of hull value (versus ~0.25% pre-war) and Gulf-to-China shipping costs are running roughly four times the five-year pre-conflict average. This is the dominant swing factor for oil, tankers, insurance and jet fuel today — a confirmed deal would likely hit Brent and tanker rates hard; continued deadlock or a fresh attack would do the opposite.

Israel kills 11 in Lebanon strikes; Kushner holds Hamas talks in Egypt on a Gaza ceasefire plan Israel has rejected, meets Netanyahu today

[Al Jazeera](#) / [CNN](#) • Sat 15 – Sun 16 Aug

Israeli strikes in southern Lebanon killed at least 11 people on Saturday in response to a Hezbollah attack that wounded three Israeli soldiers; the IDF said it killed a Hezbollah Radwan Force commander. Separately, Jared Kushner met Hamas leadership in Egypt on Sunday to advance a Gaza ceasefire plan that Israel has so far rejected, and is due to meet Israeli PM Netanyahu today. Yemen's Mokha port also suspended operations after 25-plus Houthi missiles killed seven and caused roughly \$16m of damage. Keeps the geopolitical-risk premium live across defense, energy and aviation names.

Japan's Q2 GDP badly misses forecasts; Asian markets mixed and cautious overnight, Kospi shut for Liberation Day

[Wire reports](#) • overnight Sun 16 – Mon 17 Aug

Japan's Q2 GDP grew at an annualised 1.1%, far short of the 2.0% consensus. The Nikkei 225 was little changed (+0.13% intraday) while the broader Topix slipped 0.45%; Hang Seng futures were the regional outperformer, up 0.6%. South Korea's Kospi is closed today as Liberation Day (15 August) falls on a Saturday and is observed on the Monday. The cautious tone follows Friday's softer Wall Street finish and awaits progress on the Hormuz talks. A quiet, headline-driven overnight session with limited directional signal for Europe.

Applied Materials beats but falls on margin/growth-pace concerns; Canada racing to avert 50% US tariff before 19 August deadline

[Investing.com](#) / [Washington Post](#) • Wed 13 & Fri-Sat 14-15 Aug

Applied Materials posted record Q3 revenue, EPS and margins (\$3.50 EPS vs \$3.40 est.; \$9.12bn revenue vs \$8.99bn est.) and raised its 2026 semiconductor-systems growth outlook to above 30% from above 20%, yet shares still fell roughly 5% after-hours on Q4 guidance and margin-pace questions — a mixed AI-capex read for European chip-equipment names (ASML, ASM International, BESI) at today's open. Separately, the US and Canada are reportedly closing in on a deal to avert a threatened 50% tariff on ~\$16bn of Canadian goods (hockey sticks, wine, cement, agriculture) due to take effect 19 August.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

CONTRACT	LEVEL	IMPLIED MOVE	COLLECTION TIME
Euro Stoxx 50 futures (FESX)	~6,551-6,586 range, last ~6,564-6,580 (no clean Monday-morning timestamp; may reflect stale weekend levels)	n/a reliable directional read	05:00-06:15 BST
DAX futures (FDAX)	n/a — no confirmed 17 Aug pre-open print found via open sources	n/a	05:00-06:15 BST
CAC 40 futures (FCE)	n/a — not found via open sources	n/a	05:00-06:15 BST
FTSE 100 futures (Z)	n/a — not found via open sources	n/a	05:00-06:15 BST
US context — futures pre-market			
S&P 500 e-mini	n/a precise level	Little changed indicated, index near record territory (one record this week, three last week)	05:00-06:15 BST
Nasdaq 100 e-mini	n/a precise level	Little changed indicated ahead of a heavy US retail-earnings week	05:00-06:15 BST

Clean pre-open futures levels for the DAX, CAC and FTSE could not be confirmed via open web access this morning; treat this section as directional context only. Underlying tone should be cautious-to-neutral: Friday's US retail-sales and consumer-sentiment misses, Asia's mixed and thin overnight session (Kospi shut, Nikkei/Topix little changed), and an unresolved Strait of Hormuz negotiation all argue against a strong directional open. Expect the session to be dominated by headline risk out of the Hormuz talks and the Kushner-Netanyahu meeting, plus the first hard US data of the week (Empire State manufacturing, NAHB housing) this afternoon.

4. LAST TRADING SESSION'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRIDAY 14 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	~6,547	+0.20%
DAX 40	26,440.31 per one source (+140.57pts); a second source instead shows −0.15% to ~26,292 — sources disagree on direction	+0.53% or −0.15% depending on source; higher-detail source (near 52-week high of 26,573.50) treated as primary
CAC 40	~8,647-8,651 (two sources differ slightly)	−0.05% to −0.28%
FTSE 100	10,750.11 per one source (−22.56pts); a second source shows −0.56% to ~10,773	−0.21% to −0.56%, fifth straight losing session per the more detailed source

European indices were mixed and largely rangebound on Friday, still trading near record territory despite the seasonal August-weakness pattern that several outlets have flagged this year as unusually absent. The FTSE 100 extended a run of losing sessions, weighed by mining stocks even as copper holds near record levels — a reminder that index-level softness can mask strength in individual names. Exact closing prints for the DAX and FTSE carry meaningful cross-source disagreement this week; direction should be treated as indicative only until confirmed against a live terminal.

5. US MARKETS — LAST SESSION (FRIDAY 14 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,785.76	−0.2% (−13.23 pts)	Third straight weekly gain despite the Friday pullback
Dow Jones Industrial Average	53,732.41	−0.2% (−107.58 pts)	
Nasdaq Composite	26,729.16	−0.3% (−73.86 pts)	Tech-led decline on the day
Russell 2000	3,068.42	+0.5% (+15.57 pts)	Small-caps outperformed large-caps

Wall Street retreated modestly from Thursday's record high after July retail sales fell 0.6% (steepest drop in over a year) and the preliminary University of Michigan consumer sentiment index sank to 51.0 from 55.2, well below its long-run average near 84. **Leading sectors (week):** Communication Services and Technology, though Technology (XLK) was the day's laggard, down roughly 0.5% on Friday specifically. **Lagging sector (week):** Energy, still negative for the year; Consumer Staples and Utilities were also soft Friday.

Key takeaway: the consumer-spending and sentiment misses reinforced the case for the Fed to hold rather than hike in September, pushing the Bloomberg Dollar Spot Index to its weakest since 29 May. This follows an early-August CME FedWatch move from ~67% odds of a September hike (31 July) to ~44% (7 Aug) after a weak July payrolls report (+23,000 jobs vs +85,000 est., the third-largest monthly decline since the pandemic). The S&P nonetheless closed out a third consecutive positive week, underscoring that the underlying uptrend remains intact even as the data softens.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION (MONDAY 17 AUGUST 2026)

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	n/a precise level for today	+0.13% intraday — essentially flat
Topix (broader Japan gauge, context)	n/a precise level	−0.45%
Hang Seng	n/a cash level; futures basis used	Futures +0.6% — regional outperformer
Shanghai Composite	n/a for 17 Aug; last confirmed close 13 Aug at 3,926.96	13 Aug: −0.50%; today's print not confirmed via open sources
Kospi (South Korea)	Market closed	Closed — Liberation Day (15 Aug, a Saturday) observed today; reopens Tuesday 18 Aug

A thin, cautious overnight session with limited directional conviction. Japan's Q2 GDP grew at an annualised 1.1%, well below the 2.0% consensus, capping the Nikkei near flat and dragging the broader Topix lower; South Korea was shut for the observed Liberation Day holiday, removing one of the region's more volatile recent movers. Hong Kong futures led regional gains, though a firm cash-market read could not be confirmed. The tone follows Friday's softer Wall Street finish and reflects traders positioning cautiously ahead of a possible Strait of Hormuz shipping resolution. Limited fresh read-through for European equities at today's open beyond the general risk-cautious tone.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	TIME
Brent (ICE, USD/bbl)	~\$88.0-89.4	Fri settled above \$88, +~5% on the week on Hormuz-deal uncertainty; Mon morning range \$88.02-89.39, opened ~\$88.85	Fri 14 – Mon 17 Aug
WTI (NYMEX, USD/bbl)	~\$82.4	Fri close ~\$82.40, +1.4% d/d	Fri 14 Aug
Gold (XAU/USD, USD/oz)	~\$4,405-4,420	Holding above \$4,400, rebounding after Friday's pullback	Mon 17 Aug morning
Natural gas (Henry Hub, USD/MMBtu)	\$2.665	–1.84% d/d	Fri 14 Aug
Natural gas (European TTF, EUR/MWh)	~€61.4 (Fri close); today's level n/a — low-confidence forecast source put Monday near €49, not used	Fri: +1.7% d/d, a three-week high, on Qatari LNG cargo disruption forcing European buyers to compete harder with Asian importers	Fri 14 Aug
Copper (COMEX, USD/lb / LME, USD/tonne)	Record >\$6.70/lb (Comex, set 6 Aug); LME record >\$14,300/tonne	Holding near record levels on Chile supply disruption and shrinking global inventories	As of 6-14 Aug window

Oil remains firmly bid on unresolved Strait of Hormuz negotiations — Brent is up roughly 5% on the week and sits close to \$88-89/bbl; a confirmed Iran-Oman-US shipping deal would be the single biggest reversal risk to the downside today. Gold continues to hold a firm bid above \$4,400/oz, rebounding after Friday's pullback, supported by the same Fed-hike-versus-hold uncertainty and Middle East risk that has underpinned bullion all month. European TTF gas jumped to a three-week high above €61/MWh on Friday as Qatari LNG disruption forces European buyers into competition with Asian importers ahead of winter — a live watch item given the potential read-through to inflation and utilities. Copper remains near its 6 August record, supporting realised prices for European and UK-listed miners even as some producers (see Stocks to Watch) cut volume guidance.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	TIME
US Treasury 10-year	4.68%	Ticked slightly higher as traders digested soft retail sales alongside Middle East risk	Fri 14 Aug close
German Bund 10-year	~3.10% (range through August; no single dated Monday print confirmed)	Swinging on shifting Strait of Hormuz signals and the resulting oil-price/inflation impact	Through week of 10-14 Aug
EUR/USD	1.1573	+0.36% d/d	Fri 14 Aug close (~22:30 GMT)
GBP/USD	~1.348-1.355 (week's range; high 1.35545 on 14 Aug)	Near recent highs	Week of 10-14 Aug
DXY (ICE Dollar Index)	~99.6-99.8	Near a two-month low, having approached 95.53 on 7 Aug; separately the Bloomberg Dollar Spot Index (a different, broader basket) fell 0.4% Friday to its weakest since 29 May	Fri 14 Aug

None of the figures above could be confirmed as a genuine real-time Monday pre-08:00 BST print; all reflect the latest confirmed Friday levels and should be re-checked against a live terminal before use. The dollar's weakness is the dominant rates/FX theme: weak July retail sales and a soft July payrolls report have pushed September Fed hike odds down from roughly 67% (31 July) to roughly 44% (7 Aug) per CME FedWatch, even as the Fed remains in an unusual hiking-bias regime rather than a cutting one. The Treasury 10-year ticked marginally higher Friday despite the weak data, suggesting Middle East-linked inflation risk is still competing with growth-scare dynamics for the rates market's attention. EUR/USD and GBP/USD both sit near recent multi-week highs as a result of broad dollar softness.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

LAST WEEK'S ISSUANCES (WEEK OF 10-14 AUGUST 2026)

ISSUER	CURRENCY	SIZE	MATURITY	COUPON/SPREAD	NOTES
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No EUR-denominated institutional corporate IG, HY, SSA or FIG benchmark deal could be confirmed as pricing in the week of 10-14 August 2026 — consistent with the well-documented mid-July-to-mid-August SSA/corporate primary drought (last confirmed EUR SSA benchmark dates to early July). One near-term signal: IBB (Investitionsbank Berlin) has mandated a bank for a €0.5bn social bond tap, seen as an early test of post-summer demand ahead of a wider reopening. n/a for confirmed priced benchmark deals last week — not fabricated.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED THIS WEEK

GlobalCapital and market commentary consistently describe an "extremely busy" euro SSA restart beginning this week, after a lull dating back to mid-July. Historically (per last year's pattern cited in trade press), German issuers and a Länder name are typically first out after the summer break in mid-August, followed by KfW; World Bank (IBRD), KfW and the Republic of Finland are all flagged as likely to play a leading role in this reopening. IBB's mandated €0.5bn social bond tap is the most concrete near-term data point. No specific corporate IG/HY mandate or rumoured name could be confirmed for today via open sources.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	MOVE / DIRECTION	AS OF
iTraxx Europe Main 5yr	n/a — no current print found via open sources	—	—
iTraxx Europe Crossover 5yr	~315-320bp (STALE — mid-May reference)	Not day-of; indicative/historical only	Mid-May 2026
CDX IG 5yr (USD)	n/a — no current print found via open sources	—	—
CDX.NA.HY 5yr (USD, context)	~358bp (STALE — mid-May reference)	Not day-of; indicative/historical only	Mid-May 2026
Avg euro corporate IG spread (OAS)	n/a — not found	—	—

None of the spread figures above could be confirmed as current for the 14-17 August window; none were cross-checked across two independent same-week sources. Treat as last-known reference points only — a live terminal check is required before use.

COMMENTARY

Euro primary is at the hinge point of its seasonal calendar — the mid-July-to-mid-August drought is expected to give way to an "extremely busy" restart from this week, led by SSA issuers (IBB's mandated tap is the clearest early signal, with World Bank, KfW and Finland flagged as likely follow-on names). Separate GlobalCapital reporting from earlier in the summer noted euro IG corporate new-issue premiums (NIPs) climbing as order books thinned into the holiday period, a sign investors were demanding more concession even before the full drought set in — worth watching as a gauge of investor appetite once volumes

resume. The backdrop for issuance is broadly constructive: European banks are on a two-year profit run (EURO STOXX Banks index at its highest since the 2007-08 financial crisis) and miners/energy names are enjoying elevated commodity prices, both supportive for FIG and industrials/energy paper respectively. No day-of sector skew can be established given the lack of confirmed prints this week; recommend a live IFR/GlobalCapital/Bloomberg check once the market reopens in earnest.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR (TODAY, 17 AUGUST 2026)

TIME (BST)	REGION	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
Overnight (released)	Japan	Q2 2026 GDP, preliminary (annualised)	Consensus 2.0%; actual 1.1% — a significant miss	HIGH
Overnight (released)	China	July activity data bundle (retail sales, industrial production, fixed-asset investment)	No consensus figure confirmed via open sources	MEDIUM
13:30	Canada	CPI (July)	No consensus figure confirmed via open sources	MEDIUM
13:30	US	NY Empire State Manufacturing Index (August)	Prior 15.6 (July, +10pt jump)	MEDIUM
15:00	US	NAHB/Wells Fargo Housing Market Index (August)	Expected roughly unchanged near 72	MEDIUM

No Eurozone or UK data releases were confirmed for today via open sources — the next UK data point is Tuesday's labour-market report, followed by UK CPI and the July FOMC minutes on Wednesday. No ECB, BoE or Fed policy decision falls today: the ECB holds at 2.25% (next decision 10 September), the BoE holds at 3.75% (next decision 17 September) and the Fed holds at 3.50-3.75% under Chair Kevin Warsh (next FOMC 15-16 September). Today's calendar is genuinely thin for Europe; the main live catalysts are the Strait of Hormuz negotiation headlines and this afternoon's first hard US data (Empire State manufacturing, NAHB housing) since Friday's weak retail sales and consumer sentiment prints.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

COMPANY	MARKET	EVENT	TIME
No major confirmed European large-cap earnings release could be verified for today via open search (paywalled/JIS-gated calendars) — not itemized rather than guessed. Check Investegate/LSE RNS/MarketScreener Europe at the open for confirmation.			
Applied Materials (NASDAQ: AMAT)	US	Reported fiscal Q3 2026 results Wed 13 Aug after the close — beat estimates and raised FY26 semiconductor-systems growth guidance to >30%, but shares fell ~5% after-hours on margin/growth-pace concerns	Reported Wed 13 Aug
DHT Holdings (NYSE: DHT)	US (tanker, European read-through)	Reported Q2 2026 results 5 Aug — ~135% y/y revenue growth; subsequently downgraded by Evercore to "In Line" on reversion risk	Reported 5 Aug; downgrade this week
Walmart / Home Depot / Target / Lowe's / TJX	US	US retail-earnings gauntlet reports later this week (Tue-Thu) — key read on the health of the US consumer after Friday's retail-sales/sentiment misses	Later this week (18-20 Aug)

Today's confirmed corporate slate is thin on both sides of the Atlantic — aggregator data suggests roughly 44 US companies report Monday but no market-moving large-cap was confirmed for today specifically via open sources. The week's real corporate catalyst is the US retail-earnings gauntlet starting tomorrow, a direct read on consumer resilience after Friday's weak retail-sales print. In Europe, the SSA bond-market restart (see DCM section) is arguably the more relevant "corporate event" of the day for market-watchers, alongside ongoing headline risk from the IBB mandate and any further bank or miner earnings follow-through.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

Frontline / DHT Holdings / Nordic American Tanker — Shipping	Evercore cut DHT and Frontline to "In Line" and downgraded Nordic American Tanker further to "Underperform" this week on "reversion risk," even as Q2 revenue surged (Frontline +67% y/y, DHT +135% y/y) on Hormuz-driven VLCC rates. A confirmed Hormuz shipping deal would accelerate the normalisation these downgrades anticipate.	Event-risk / downgrade pressure vs still-elevated rates
BP (LSE: BP) / Shell (LSE: SHEL) — Energy	Brent holding near \$88-89/bbl, +~5% on the week, on unresolved Strait of Hormuz talks. A confirmed shipping-access deal is the single biggest headline risk to the current oil-price premium underpinning recent sector strength.	Headline-risk both ways
IAG (LSE: IAG) / Lufthansa (ETR: LHA) — Aviation	IAG's Q2 profit fell 16% on Iran-war-linked fuel costs and Middle East route suspensions, with H1 group capacity down 0.1% y/y versus an original 2.5-3% growth target; Lufthansa capacity down 10.8%. Middle East exposure is modest (1-2% of capacity) but the fuel-cost and disruption drag is broad-based.	Bearish / event-risk
Ryanair / easyJet (LSE: EZJ) — Aviation	Relative winners versus the flag carriers: Ryanair is Europe's largest carrier in August 2026 with 22.2m seats (+6% y/y), easyJet has grown capacity 3% y/y, both continuing to expand while IAG and Lufthansa retrench around Middle East disruption.	Relative outperformance
Rheinmetall (ETR: RHM) / BAE Systems (LSE: BA.) — Aerospace & Defense	Full-year guidance intact (Rheinmetall +40-45% sales growth), but both names have shown sharp sensitivity to peace-process headlines this year (April 2026: Rheinmetall -5.9%, BAE -3.3% on Russia-Ukraine deal-progress reports). Today's Kushner-Netanyahu meeting on a Gaza ceasefire is a fresh catalyst to watch.	Event-risk / headline-sensitive
Glencore (LSE: GLEN) — Metals & Mining	H1 adjusted EBITDA jumped 86% to \$10.1bn on war-driven trading profits and a 15% rise in copper output, with copper still trading near its 6 August record (>\$6.70/lb Comex, >\$14,300/tonne LME).	Bullish
Antofagasta (LSE: ANTO) — Metals & Mining	H1 pre-tax profit up 72% on record copper prices, but shares fell 5% after the group cut its 2026 copper production guidance to 625,000-655,000 tonnes from 650,000-700,000 tonnes — a reminder that price strength is not fully offsetting supply-side disappointment.	Bullish on price, bearish on the guidance cut
Barclays (LSE: BARC) / UBS (SIX: UBSG) — Banks	European banks are on a two-year profit run, with the EURO STOXX Banks index at its highest level since the 2007-08 financial crisis. Barclays' H1 profit rose 17% but shares fell as equities trading undershot expectations and costs ran higher; UBS delivered a ~17% return on CET1 capital, above its 15% target.	Bullish sector momentum, stock-specific dispersion on execution

**ASML / ASM
International / BE
Semiconductor —
Semiconductors**

Applied Materials beat estimates and raised 2026 semiconductor-systems growth guidance to >30%, yet fell ~5% after-hours on Q4 margin and growth-pace questions — a mixed AI-capex signal for European chip-equipment names at today's open.

Mixed read-through

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

US consumer cracks: July retail sales fell 0.6% m/m, the steepest drop in over a year, and the preliminary University of Michigan sentiment index sank to 51.0 from 55.2, ending a two-month recovery. Households cited Iran-war-linked fuel, energy and food costs as key pressures — older, lower-income and non-college-educated consumers showed the largest sentiment declines.

Fed hike-odds recede further: the Bloomberg Dollar Spot Index fell to its weakest since 29 May on Friday as traders pared September hike bets. CME FedWatch-implied odds of a September hike fell from roughly 67% (31 July) to roughly 44% (7 Aug) after a weak July payrolls report (+23,000 jobs vs +85,000 est., the third-largest monthly decline since the pandemic) — though the Fed under new Chair Kevin Warsh remains in an unusual hiking-bias regime rather than a clean cutting cycle.

Japan growth miss: Q2 GDP grew at an annualised 1.1%, far below the 2.0% consensus, adding to a broader global growth-scare narrative alongside Friday's US data.

Jackson Hole looms: the Kansas City Fed's Economic Symposium runs 27-29 August, with new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh delivering his first keynote as chair on Friday 28 August, expected to focus on "long-term structural questions" rather than near-term policy guidance.

CORPORATE

Banks: Europe's banking sector remains on a two-year bull run, with the EURO STOXX Banks index at its highest since the 2007-08 financial crisis on strong lending margins and trading revenue. Barclays posted 17% H1 profit growth (shares fell on higher costs and an equities miss); UBS delivered a ~17% return on CET1 capital.

Miners: Glencore's H1 adjusted EBITDA jumped 86% to \$10.1bn on war-driven trading profits and higher copper output; Antofagasta's profit rose 72% but the group cut its 2026 copper production guidance, sending shares down 5%.

Airlines: IAG's Q2 profit fell 16% on Iran-war fuel costs and Middle East capacity cuts, while Ryanair and easyJet continue to expand capacity, taking share from the retrenching flag carriers.

Tech/AI-capex: Applied Materials beat estimates and raised guidance but fell ~5% after-hours — the latest in a run of "beat-and-sell-off" reactions across AI-infrastructure names this earnings season.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Strait of Hormuz: Iran, Oman and the US are reportedly in the "final stages" of a deal on shipping control and transit fees, aimed at restoring the 17 June US-Iran ceasefire. No agreement was confirmed as of this morning. War-risk insurance remains at 7.5-10% of hull value versus ~0.25% pre-war, and Gulf-to-China shipping costs are running roughly four times the pre-conflict average. This is the dominant macro swing factor across oil, shipping, aviation and inflation expectations today.

Lebanon/Gaza: Israeli strikes killed 11 people in southern Lebanon on Saturday in response to a Hezbollah attack that wounded three Israeli soldiers. Jared Kushner met Hamas leadership in Egypt on Sunday to advance a Gaza ceasefire plan that Israel has so far rejected, and is due to meet PM Netanyahu today — a fresh geopolitical catalyst for the session.

Yemen: Houthi forces fired more than 25 missiles at Yemen's Mokha port over the weekend, killing seven and causing an estimated \$16m in damage, forcing the port to suspend operations — a reminder that Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb disruption risk persists alongside the Hormuz situation.

US tariffs: the US and Canada are reportedly close to a deal to avert a threatened 50% tariff on roughly \$16bn of Canadian goods (agriculture, dairy, furniture, alcoholic beverages and more), due to take effect 19 August under Section 338. A 15% tariff plus price floors on polysilicon imports took effect 6 August.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. Strait of Hormuz deal endgame

Iran-Oman-US talks reportedly in "final stages"; a confirmed deal would sharply reprice oil, tankers and insurance lower, deadlock or a fresh attack would do the opposite.

2. First hard US data since Friday's consumer scare

Empire State manufacturing (13:30 BST) and NAHB housing (15:00 BST) are the session's live US catalysts.

3. Euro SSA primary reopening

An "extremely busy" restart is expected this week after a month-long drought; IBB's mandated tap is the first concrete test of demand.

4. Kushner-Netanyahu meeting on Gaza

Outcome of today's meeting could move defense names and broader risk sentiment given the rejected ceasefire plan.

5. AI-capex read-through into European semis

Applied Materials' beat-and-sell-off reaction sets a mixed tone for ASML, ASMI and BESI at today's open.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. UK data wave: labour market (Tue), CPI (Wed)

First UK releases of the week, key inputs into the BoE's 17 September decision.

2. July FOMC minutes, Wednesday 19 August

First detailed look at the internal Fed debate under new Chair Kevin Warsh's hiking-bias regime.

3. US retail-earnings gauntlet

Walmart, Home Depot, Target, Lowe's and TJX report Tue-Thu — a direct read on consumer health after Friday's weak retail sales.

4. PBOC rate decision and Australia jobs, Thursday

Asian-region policy and labour data ahead of Friday's global flash PMIs.

5. Flash PMIs and UK retail sales, Friday 21 August

Germany, eurozone, UK and US composite PMIs plus UK retail sales close out the week's data calendar.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Jackson Hole Economic Symposium, 27-29 August

New Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first keynote as chair, Friday 28 August — especially significant given the live hike-versus-hold debate.

2. Strait of Hormuz / Iran conflict trajectory

Remains the dominant macro tail risk for oil, shipping, aviation and inflation through the month.

3. Canada-US tariff deadline, 19 August

A threatened 50% tariff on ~\$16bn of Canadian goods takes effect unless a deal is reached this week.

4. September euro DCM supply wave building

This week's SSA restart is the first leg of a broader September issuance wave following the summer lull.

5. Next FOMC (15-16 Sept), ECB (10 Sept) and BoE (17 Sept)

All three central banks face a live hike/hold debate this cycle; positioning builds through the rest of August.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Hormuz deal headline risk: confirmation or breakdown of the Iran-Oman-US shipping talks could swing oil, tankers and insurance sharply in either direction intraday.

US Empire State/NAHB data at 13:30/15:00 BST — the first hard US releases since Friday's consumer-spending scare.

SSA reopening headlines following IBB's mandated tap, an early test of post-summer investor demand.

Kushner-Netanyahu meeting on a Gaza ceasefire plan Israel has so far rejected.

1 WEEK

Tuesday-Wednesday: UK labour market and CPI data, plus the July FOMC minutes.

Tuesday-Thursday: US retail-earnings gauntlet (Walmart, Home Depot, Target, Lowe's, TJX) testing the post-retail-sales-miss consumer narrative.

Thursday-Friday: PBOC rate decision, Australia jobs, then global flash PMIs and UK retail sales.

Ongoing: euro DCM reopening momentum building into a heavier SSA/corporate IG week.

1 MONTH

19 August: Canada-US 50% tariff deadline.

27-29 August: Jackson Hole Economic Symposium, with Chair Warsh's first keynote on 28 August.

10, 15-16 and 17 September: ECB, FOMC and BoE decisions respectively — all three central banks face a live hike/hold question this cycle.

Ongoing: Strait of Hormuz/Iran conflict remains the dominant tail risk through the month; September euro DCM supply wave builds through late August following this week's SSA restart.

SOURCES

- CNN Business / CFO Dive / Marketplace / Yahoo Finance — July US retail sales, Michigan consumer sentiment
- Bloomberg — Dollar Spot Index weakness, September Fed hike-odds recalibration
- AP wire (via Bozeman Daily Chronicle / Barchart mirrors) / TheStreet / Yahoo Finance / CNBC — US index closes, Friday 14 Aug session
- BBNTimes / TradingEconomics / 24/7 Wall St / MarketScreener — European index closes and futures (cross-source figures flagged inline where inconsistent)
- Euronews / Yahoo Finance — European August seasonality context
- CNBC / Washington Post — Asian markets overnight, Japan Q2 GDP miss, Kospi Liberation Day closure
- Al Jazeera / CNN / CBS News — Strait of Hormuz talks, Lebanon strikes, Gaza ceasefire talks, Yemen/Houthi attacks
- The National / IndexBox / S&P Global — war-risk shipping insurance premiums, Hormuz shipping-cost context
- Forbes Advisor / TradingEconomics / JM Bullion — Brent, WTI, gold pricing
- TradingEconomics — Henry Hub and European TTF natural gas pricing
- Mining.com / MoneyMagpie / Proactive Investors — copper record pricing, Glencore, Antofagasta
- Seeking Alpha / ETFdb / CNBC — US 10-year Treasury yield
- TradingEconomics / Yahoo Finance — German Bund 10-year yield context, EUR/USD, GBP/USD, DXY

- GlobalCapital / IFR (search-snippet access; direct fetch blocked) — DCM primary market colour, SSA restart, IBB mandate, credit spread context
- LiteFinance / Newsquawk / Nexus Forex Trading — weekly economic calendar, 17-21 August 2026
- Investing.com — NY Empire State Manufacturing Index, NAHB Housing Market Index schedule
- Federal Reserve Board / Kansas City Fed / MarketPulse (OANDA) — Jackson Hole 2026 dates, Chair Warsh's keynote
- Investing.com / Schaeffer's / TradingKey / 24/7 Wall St — Applied Materials Q3 2026 earnings and stock reaction
- Investing.com (analyst ratings) / 24/7 Wall St / Streetwise Reports — Frontline, DHT Holdings, Nordic American Tanker
- MarketScreener / Aviation Source News / Proactive Investors / Travel Extra — IAG, Lufthansa, Ryanair, easyJet capacity data
- CNBC — Rheinmetall/BAE Systems sales guidance and peace-process sensitivity context
- Investing.com (Reuters) / International Finance / KFGO — European bank earnings, EURO STOXX Banks index
- Washington Post — Canada-US tariff negotiations ahead of 19 August deadline
- Bank of England / European Central Bank / Federal Reserve — policy meeting dates and current rates

Data collected automatically between approximately 05:00 and 06:15 BST on 17 August 2026 via open web search. Direct WebFetch access to several primary sources (GlobalCapital, IFR, some Bloomberg and TradingEconomics pages) was blocked or limited throughout this session; figures from those sources come from search-engine snippet summaries rather than direct page reads. A significant number of figures are marked n/a, given as source ranges, or explicitly flagged as cross-source inconsistent — this applies in particular to DAX/CAC/FTSE futures levels, the exact DAX and FTSE Friday cash closes, Monday-morning rates/FX prints, current-day DCM spread levels, and Nikkei/Hang Seng/Shanghai precise levels for today's session. Verify all figures against a live terminal before making any decision. This document is not investment advice.